THE IVORY CRADLE SCHOOL

The First Overnight Shift

Field reference & practice worksheet

01 Arrival handoff

CONFIRM WITH THE PARENTS

- ☐ Last feed and next feeding plan
- ☐ Safe sleep space
- ☐ When and how to wake a parent
- ☐ Pediatrician's after-hours number
- ☐ Home address

Read back any unclear instructions.

02 Overnight essentials

Safe sleep

Place baby on their **back** in a **separate**, safety-approved crib, bassinet, portable crib, or play yard. Use a **firm, flat, level surface** with a **fitted sheet only**. [1]

Feeding

Start with **clean hands and supplies**.

FORMULA	Use prepared formula within **2 hours of preparation** and **1 hour of starting the feed**. Discard leftovers.
EXPRESSED BREAST MILK	Warmed expressed breast milk has a **2-hour limit**.

Follow the CDC guidance for leftovers and storage. [2, 3]

ESCALATION

Call 911 immediately

In the U.S., call 911 immediately for **no breathing**, **unresponsiveness**, **severe trouble breathing**, or **blue/gray lips or face**.

Newborn fever

For a newborn with a rectal temperature of **100.4°F (38°C) or higher**, notify the parent immediately and contact the pediatrician or after-hours service right away for urgent evaluation. [4, 5]

03 Practice the handoff

A The parents remember different last-feed times, **7:30** and **8:00 p.m.** What would you ask before they go to bed?

B **Write a factual log entry.** At 11:05 p.m., you offer 2 oz of formula. Baby takes 1.5 oz, has a wet diaper, and returns to the bassinet at 11:30 p.m.

TIME	CARE / OBSERVATION	ACTION

Morning handoff Lead with **urgent concerns and follow-up**, then recap the last feed and diaper, sleep, and who was contacted. **Confirm the parent has taken over.**

SOURCES [1] AAP Safe Sleep · [2] CDC Formula Preparation · [3] CDC Breast Milk Storage · [4] AAP Fever and Your Baby · [5] AAP When to Call EMS

Practice with fictional details. Follow the baby's clinician-directed care plan for individualized instructions.